

They got it all wrong!

Dear Sumod,

The article regarding the piracy of software was extremely appreciated, and I would like to present my view on the issue.

Given the sheer cost of the software today, it is no wonder that more and more people are running to the friendly neighbourhood CD-wallah for the latest software and games.

Offer them an alternative and you can see their confusion. As much as we convince ourselves, Linux still has a long way to go in becoming as user-friendly as Windows. And, we still rely on brand names to make our buying decisions. The truth is that the software offered by corporations is never going to be affordable to the general public, and piracy is here to stay.

The solutions are difficult to implement, however if we want to curtail piracy, and corporates do not want to post 'Business worth \$70 million lost due to piracy', it is time they became more people-friendly. After all, it is because of the people that they are still in business, and not the other way round.

Mukund

Via e-mail

Hi,

First of all June 2003—Nice work! I was reading about Agent 001 and found that 70 per cent of all software is pirated... well, one small doubt here. How many of us actually utilise the 15,500 bucks worth of Office XP—we use Word, with bold and italics formatting, or Adobe for viewing pictures, or at most, for simple effects. The thing is, for most of the people, it's either free or not at all. So its only 20 per cent of the users who really use the pirated software to its full potential.

Thanks

Abilash

Via e-mail

Dear Abilash and Mukund,
Well said! Everyone wants only the best, and when the resource is infinitely reproducible, such as software, it is harder to think of it as 'theft'. This is a very difficult problem to solve, especially when software prices show no signs of decline, unlike hardware prices that come down every year. While the volume of the real demand for piracy is definitely lower, it still is a significant number. According to BSA, the US has the lowest rate of piracy in the world, but still in excess of 20 per cent.

digit

Languages

In your article 'One World, One Language', you have written that we can convert any language into English. But how do we find out the language in which the letter is written?

Sanchit

Via e-mail

Dear Sanchit,

Just as language translators are available online, there are also language guessers on the Net. One of the most popular ones is TextCat Language Guesser (<http://odur.let.rug.nl/~van Noord/TextCat/Demo/textcat.html>), which not translate the text, but will tell you what language it is in.

digit

Calling Vikram

Hello,

I read the letter by Vikram from Orissa (Digit, June 2003, Short Bytes), with great interest. I live in the remotest part of the country, where I read each issue of my technology navigator only by the 20th of the month. I have an assembled computer with a modest CPU speed of 1.6 GHz.

The new games reviewed in Digit interest me a lot and I would love to have them. However, I don't have the means to buy a legitimate copy, nor can I find pirated copies. I would like to get in touch with Mr. Vikram and pursue his offer of pirated games.

V. Malsawma

Via e-mail



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana Cooper

Respected sir,

This is my first letter to Digit. I just wanted to know the e-mail ID of Vikram (refer to Digit, June 2003).

Tauseef

Via e-mail

Dear Sumod,

Your anniversary issue was fantastic. Please give me the e-mail id of Vikram mentioned in the past issue?

Ganesh

Via e-mail

In the June Issue, there is a letter from Vikram in which he talks of pirated game CDs costing Rs 25. Please give me his e-mail ID.

Ankit

Via e-mail

Dear Readers,

As an instant validation of the popularity of pirated software, Vikram seems to much sought after for his Rs 25 CDs. However, we are unable to honour any requests to get in touch with him.

digit

digit READERPOLLS

Q. What kind of forum would you like to use on the Digit Web site?

Trouble shooting and advice	Buying discussions	Magazine feedback	All of the above
36%	6%	4 %	54%

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Question: Do you think publishing bad after-sales experiences that our readers endure will help improve vendor's service levels?

☐ Yes ☐ No

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